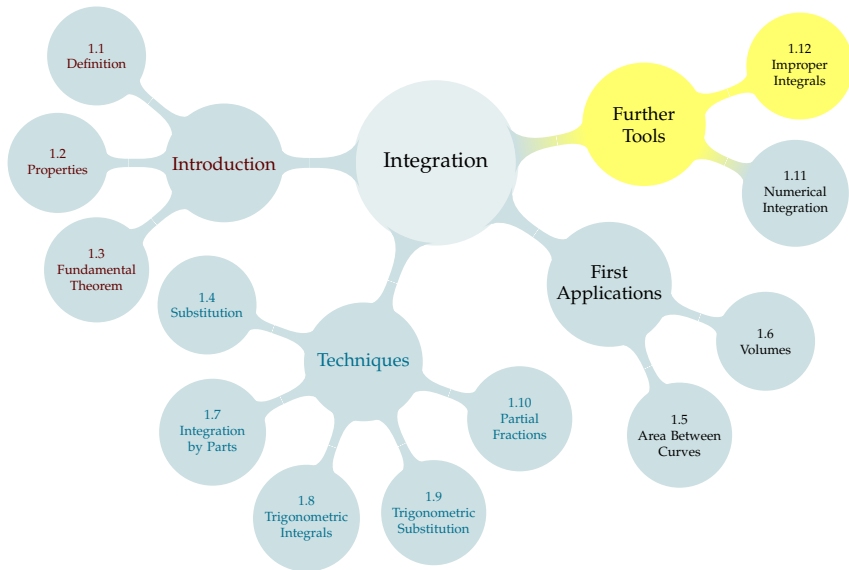
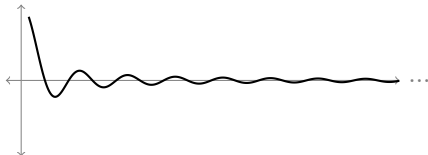


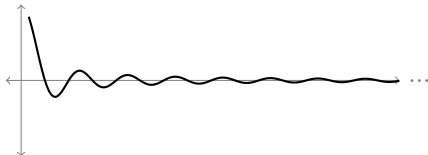
TABLE OF CONTENTS



- The region of integration is unbounded, e.g. $\int_1^\infty \frac{\sin x}{x} dx$



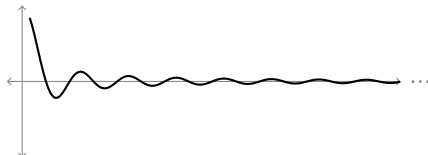
- The region of integration is unbounded, e.g. $\int_1^\infty \frac{\sin x}{x} dx$



$$\Delta x = \frac{b-a}{n} = \frac{\infty}{n} ???$$

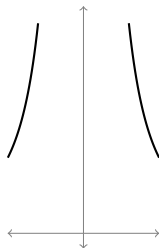
An integral is **improper** if one or both of the following happen:

- The region of integration is unbounded, e.g. $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{\sin x}{x} dx$



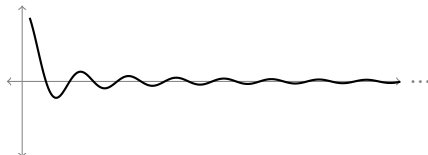
$$\Delta x = \frac{b-a}{n} = \frac{\infty}{n} ???$$

- The integrand is unbounded over the interval, e.g. $\int_{-1}^1 \frac{1}{x^2} dx$



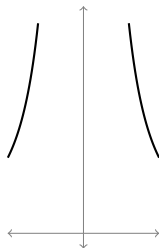
An integral is **improper** if one or both of the following happen:

- The region of integration is unbounded, e.g. $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{\sin x}{x} dx$



$$\Delta x = \frac{b-a}{n} = \frac{\infty}{n} ???$$

- The integrand is unbounded over the interval, e.g. $\int_{-1}^1 \frac{1}{x^2} dx$



$$f(0)\Delta x = ???$$

Strategy

In both cases, we eliminate the offending parts of the integral using limits.

$$\int_1^{\infty} \frac{\sin x}{x} dx =$$

$$\int_0^3 \frac{1}{x} dx =$$

If the limit doesn't exist, we say the integral **diverges**. Otherwise it **converges**.

Strategy

In both cases, we eliminate the offending parts of the integral using limits.

$$\int_1^{\infty} \frac{\sin x}{x} \, dx = \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_1^b \frac{\sin x}{x} \, dx \right]$$

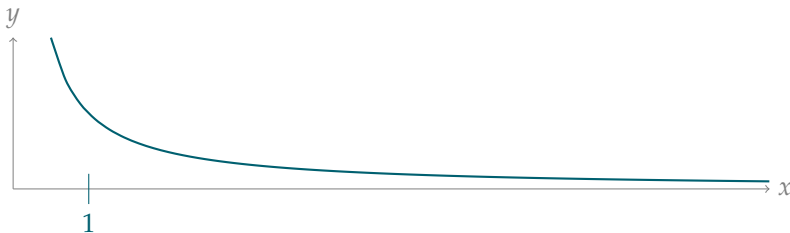
$$\int_0^3 \frac{1}{x} \, dx = \lim_{a \rightarrow 0^+} \left[\int_a^3 \frac{1}{x} \, dx \right]$$

If the limit doesn't exist, we say the integral **diverges**. Otherwise it **converges**.

$$\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x} \, dx =$$

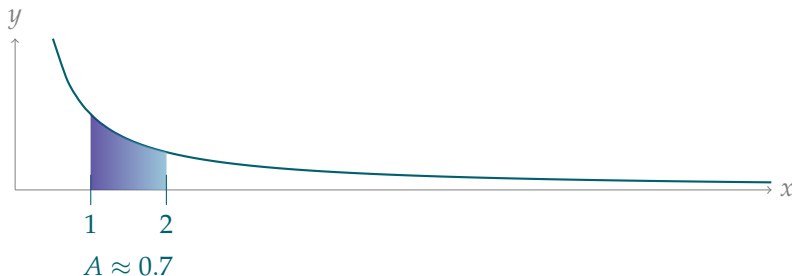
$$\begin{aligned}\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x} \, dx &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_1^a \frac{1}{x} \, dx \right] \\ &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} [\log a] = \infty\end{aligned}$$

We say this integral **diverges** because the limit is not a number.



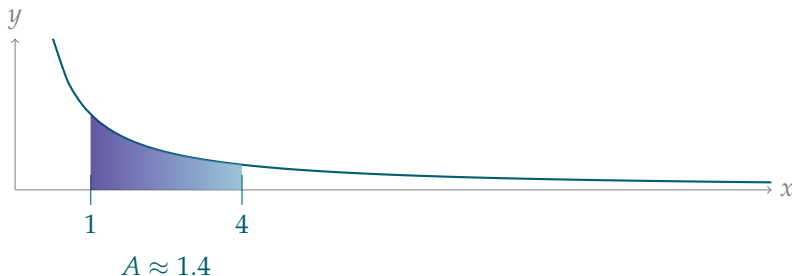
$$\begin{aligned}\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x} \, dx &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_1^a \frac{1}{x} \, dx \right] \\ &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} [\log a] = \infty\end{aligned}$$

We say this integral **diverges** because the limit is not a number.



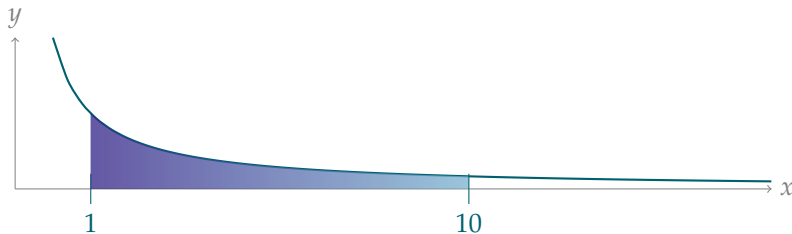
$$\begin{aligned}\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x} dx &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_1^a \frac{1}{x} dx \right] \\ &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} [\log a] = \infty\end{aligned}$$

We say this integral **diverges** because the limit is not a number.



$$\begin{aligned}\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x} \, dx &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_1^a \frac{1}{x} \, dx \right] \\ &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} [\log a] = \infty\end{aligned}$$

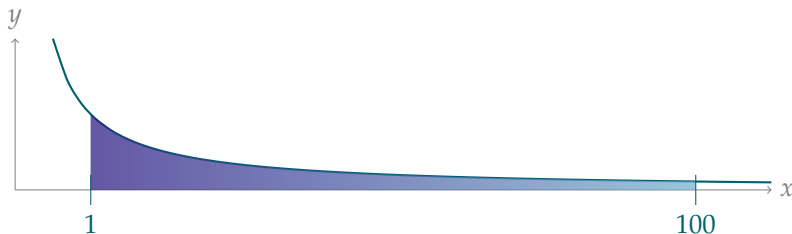
We say this integral **diverges** because the limit is not a number.



$$A \approx 2.3$$

$$\begin{aligned}\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x} \, dx &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_1^a \frac{1}{x} \, dx \right] \\ &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} [\log a] = \infty\end{aligned}$$

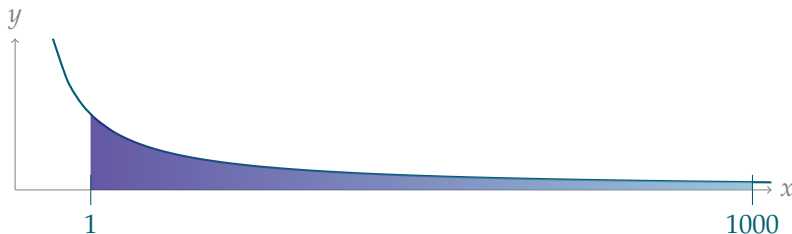
We say this integral **diverges** because the limit is not a number.



$$A \approx 4.6$$

$$\begin{aligned}\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x} \, dx &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_1^a \frac{1}{x} \, dx \right] \\ &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} [\log a] = \infty\end{aligned}$$

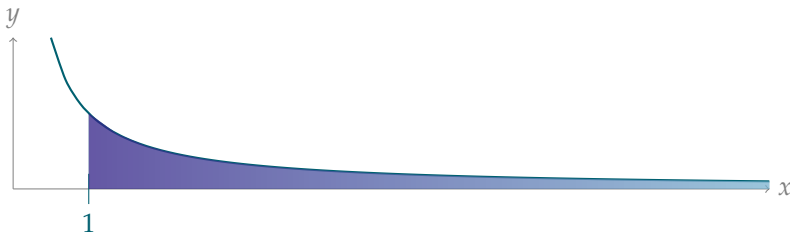
We say this integral **diverges** because the limit is not a number.



$$A \approx 6.9$$

$$\begin{aligned}\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x} dx &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_1^a \frac{1}{x} dx \right] \\ &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} [\log a] = \infty\end{aligned}$$

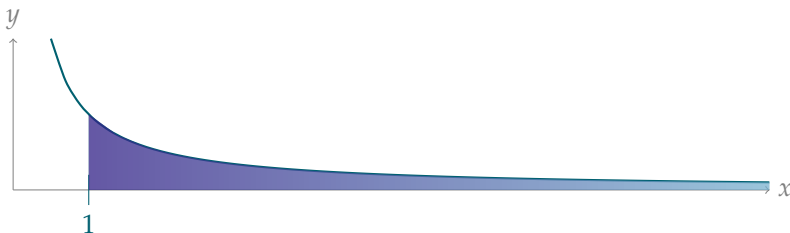
We say this integral **diverges** because the limit is not a number.



$$A \approx 1000$$

$$\begin{aligned}\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x} dx &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_1^a \frac{1}{x} dx \right] \\ &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} [\log a] = \infty\end{aligned}$$

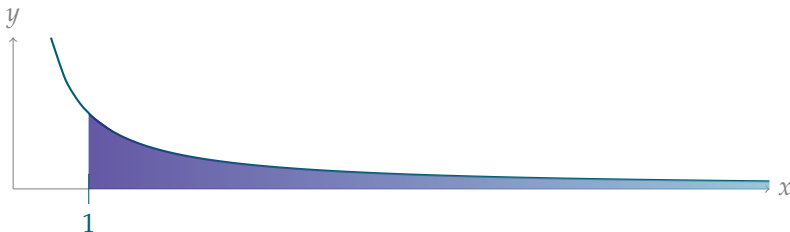
We say this integral **diverges** because the limit is not a number.



$$A \approx 1000000$$

$$\begin{aligned}\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x} dx &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_1^a \frac{1}{x} dx \right] \\ &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} [\log a] = \infty\end{aligned}$$

We say this integral **diverges** because the limit is not a number.

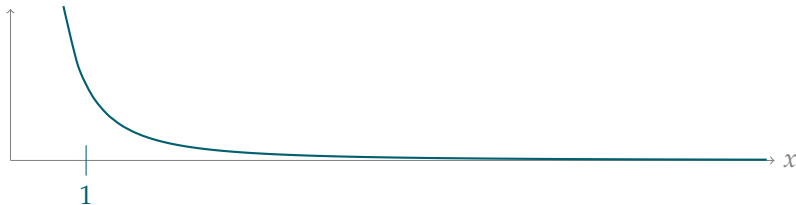


$A \approx 1000000000000$ etc

$$\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^2} dx =$$

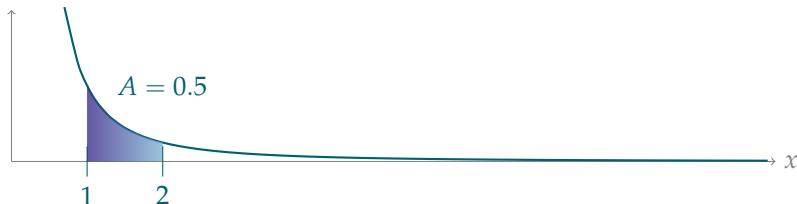
$$\begin{aligned}\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^2} dx &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_1^a \frac{1}{x^2} dx \right] \\ &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[-\frac{1}{a} + 1 \right] = 1\end{aligned}$$

We say this integral **converges** because the limit is a number.



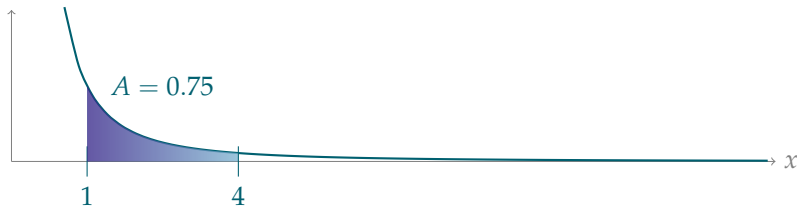
$$\begin{aligned}\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^2} dx &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_1^a \frac{1}{x^2} dx \right] \\ &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[-\frac{1}{a} + 1 \right] = 1\end{aligned}$$

We say this integral **converges** because the limit is a number.



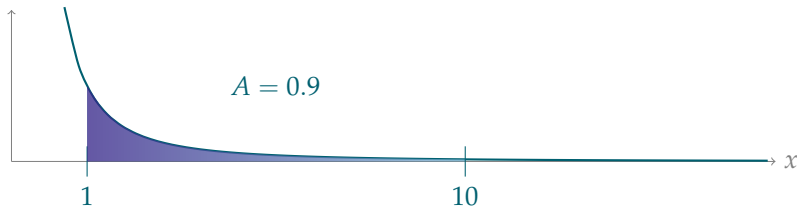
$$\begin{aligned}\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^2} dx &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_1^a \frac{1}{x^2} dx \right] \\ &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[-\frac{1}{a} + 1 \right] = 1\end{aligned}$$

We say this integral **converges** because the limit is a number.



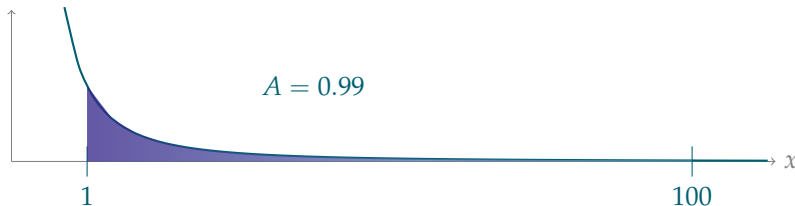
$$\begin{aligned}\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^2} dx &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_1^a \frac{1}{x^2} dx \right] \\ &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[-\frac{1}{a} + 1 \right] = 1\end{aligned}$$

We say this integral **converges** because the limit is a number.



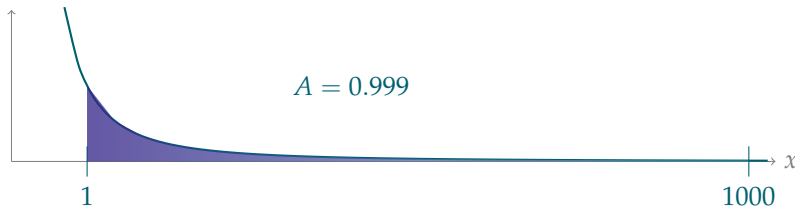
$$\begin{aligned}\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^2} dx &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_1^a \frac{1}{x^2} dx \right] \\ &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[-\frac{1}{a} + 1 \right] = 1\end{aligned}$$

We say this integral **converges** because the limit is a number.



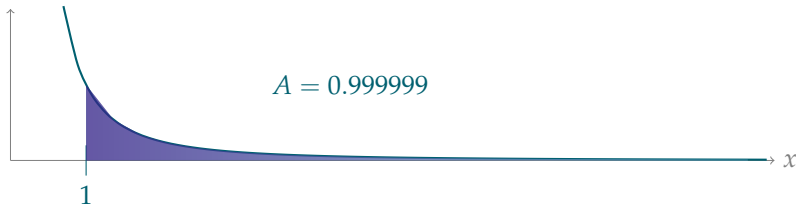
$$\begin{aligned}\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^2} dx &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_1^a \frac{1}{x^2} dx \right] \\ &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[-\frac{1}{a} + 1 \right] = 1\end{aligned}$$

We say this integral **converges** because the limit is a number.



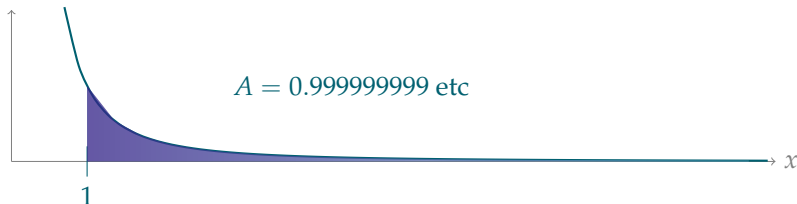
$$\begin{aligned}\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^2} dx &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_1^a \frac{1}{x^2} dx \right] \\ &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[-\frac{1}{a} + 1 \right] = 1\end{aligned}$$

We say this integral **converges** because the limit is a number.



$$\begin{aligned}\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^2} dx &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_1^a \frac{1}{x^2} dx \right] \\ &= \lim_{a \rightarrow \infty} \left[-\frac{1}{a} + 1 \right] = 1\end{aligned}$$

We say this integral **converges** because the limit is a number.



Evaluate $\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx$

When an integral has multiple sources of impropriety, we break it up into integrals that have only one source each. If all of them converge, the original integral converges. If any of them diverges, the original integral diverges as well.

Evaluate $\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx$

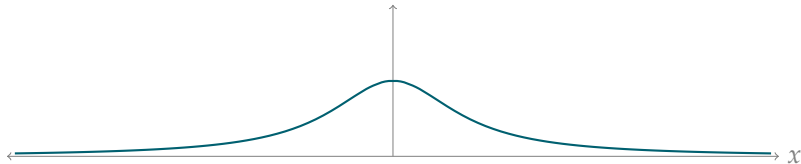
Evaluate $\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx$

$$= \int_{-\infty}^0 \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx + \int_0^{\infty} \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx$$

$$= \lim_{a \rightarrow -\infty} \left[\int_a^0 \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx \right] + \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_0^b \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx \right]$$

$$= \lim_{a \rightarrow -\infty} [\arctan 0 - \arctan a] + \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} [\arctan b - \arctan 0]$$

$$= \frac{\pi}{2} + \frac{\pi}{2} = \pi$$



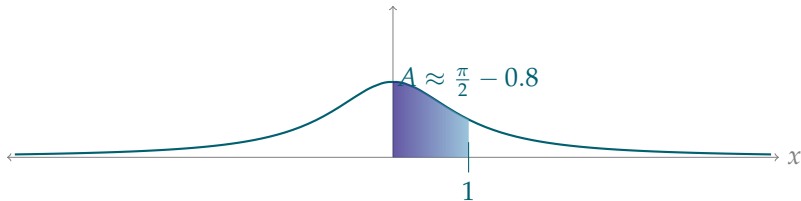
Evaluate $\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx$

$$= \int_{-\infty}^0 \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx + \int_0^{\infty} \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx$$

$$= \lim_{a \rightarrow -\infty} \left[\int_a^0 \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx \right] + \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_0^b \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx \right]$$

$$= \lim_{a \rightarrow -\infty} [\arctan 0 - \arctan a] + \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} [\arctan b - \arctan 0]$$

$$= \frac{\pi}{2} + \frac{\pi}{2} = \pi$$



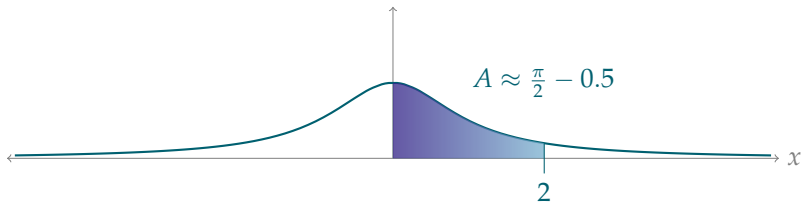
Evaluate $\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx$

$$= \int_{-\infty}^0 \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx + \int_0^{\infty} \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx$$

$$= \lim_{a \rightarrow -\infty} \left[\int_a^0 \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx \right] + \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_0^b \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx \right]$$

$$= \lim_{a \rightarrow -\infty} [\arctan 0 - \arctan a] + \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} [\arctan b - \arctan 0]$$

$$= \frac{\pi}{2} + \frac{\pi}{2} = \pi$$



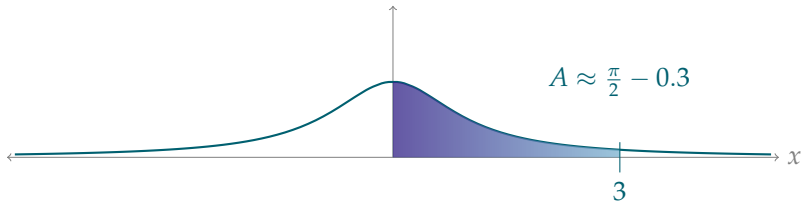
Evaluate $\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx$

$$= \int_{-\infty}^0 \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx + \int_0^{\infty} \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx$$

$$= \lim_{a \rightarrow -\infty} \left[\int_a^0 \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx \right] + \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_0^b \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx \right]$$

$$= \lim_{a \rightarrow -\infty} [\arctan 0 - \arctan a] + \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} [\arctan b - \arctan 0]$$

$$= \frac{\pi}{2} + \frac{\pi}{2} = \pi$$



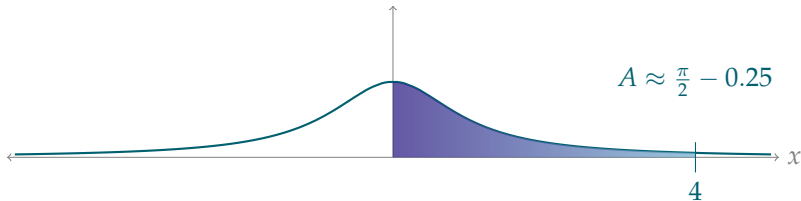
Evaluate $\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx$

$$= \int_{-\infty}^0 \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx + \int_0^{\infty} \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx$$

$$= \lim_{a \rightarrow -\infty} \left[\int_a^0 \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx \right] + \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_0^b \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx \right]$$

$$= \lim_{a \rightarrow -\infty} [\arctan 0 - \arctan a] + \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} [\arctan b - \arctan 0]$$

$$= \frac{\pi}{2} + \frac{\pi}{2} = \pi$$



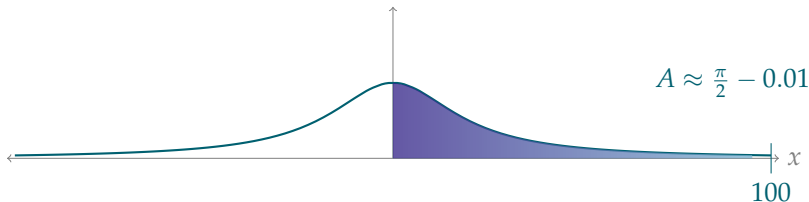
Evaluate $\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx$

$$= \int_{-\infty}^0 \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx + \int_0^{\infty} \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx$$

$$= \lim_{a \rightarrow -\infty} \left[\int_a^0 \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx \right] + \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_0^b \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx \right]$$

$$= \lim_{a \rightarrow -\infty} [\arctan 0 - \arctan a] + \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} [\arctan b - \arctan 0]$$

$$= \frac{\pi}{2} + \frac{\pi}{2} = \pi$$



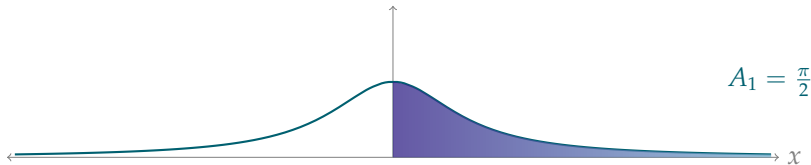
Evaluate $\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx$

$$= \int_{-\infty}^0 \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx + \int_0^{\infty} \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx$$

$$= \lim_{a \rightarrow -\infty} \left[\int_a^0 \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx \right] + \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_0^b \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx \right]$$

$$= \lim_{a \rightarrow -\infty} [\arctan 0 - \arctan a] + \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} [\arctan b - \arctan 0]$$

$$= \frac{\pi}{2} + \frac{\pi}{2} = \pi$$



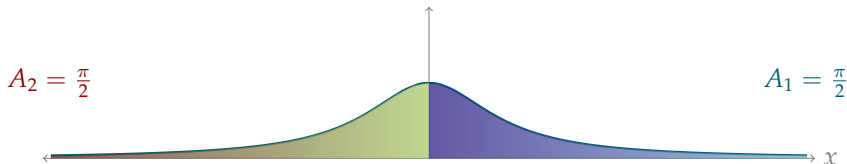
Evaluate $\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx$

$$= \int_{-\infty}^0 \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx + \int_0^{\infty} \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx$$

$$= \lim_{a \rightarrow -\infty} \left[\int_a^0 \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx \right] + \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_0^b \frac{1}{1+x^2} dx \right]$$

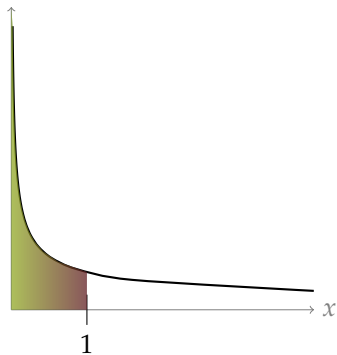
$$= \lim_{a \rightarrow -\infty} [\arctan 0 - \arctan a] + \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} [\arctan b - \arctan 0]$$

$$= \frac{\pi}{2} + \frac{\pi}{2} = \pi$$



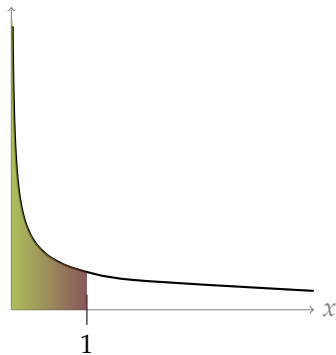
Evaluate $\int_0^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx$

Evaluate $\int_0^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx$



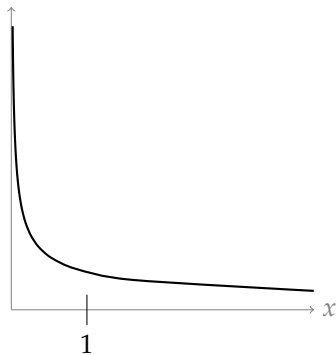
Evaluate $\int_0^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx$

Same idea: we solve our problems by ignoring them (temporarily).
Eliminate the problematic part of the integral using a limit.



Evaluate $\int_0^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx$

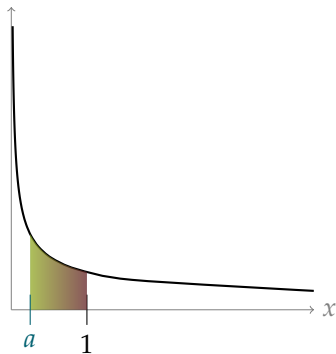
Same idea: we solve our problems by ignoring them (temporarily).
Eliminate the problematic part of the integral using a limit.



$$\int_0^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx = \lim_{a \rightarrow 0^+} \left[\int_a^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx \right]$$

Evaluate $\int_0^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx$

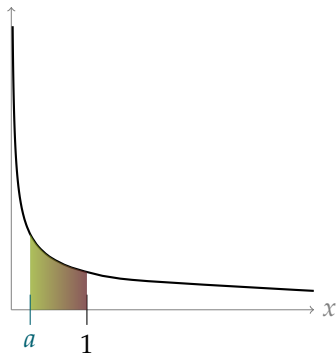
Same idea: we solve our problems by ignoring them (temporarily).
Eliminate the problematic part of the integral using a limit.



$$\int_0^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx = \lim_{a \rightarrow 0^+} \left[\int_a^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx \right]$$

Evaluate $\int_0^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx$

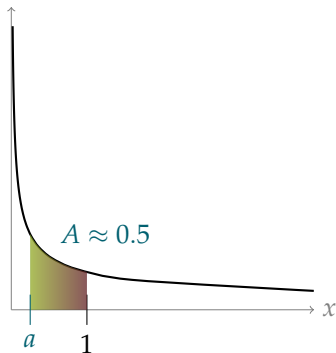
Same idea: we solve our problems by ignoring them (temporarily).
Eliminate the problematic part of the integral using a limit.



$$\int_0^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx = \lim_{a \rightarrow 0^+} \left[\int_a^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx \right] = \lim_{a \rightarrow 0^+} [1 - \sqrt{a}] = 1$$

Evaluate $\int_0^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx$

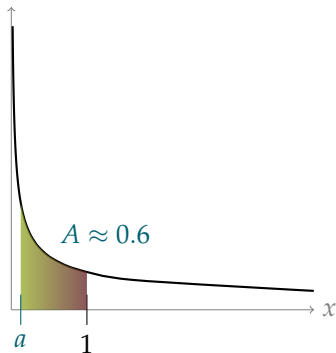
Same idea: we solve our problems by ignoring them (temporarily).
Eliminate the problematic part of the integral using a limit.



$$\int_0^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx = \lim_{a \rightarrow 0^+} \left[\int_a^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx \right] = \lim_{a \rightarrow 0^+} [1 - \sqrt{a}] = 1$$

Evaluate $\int_0^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx$

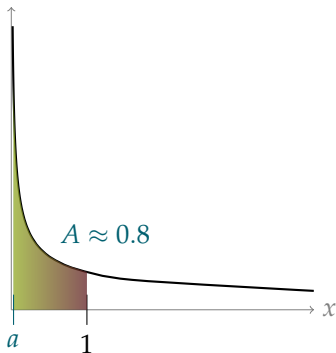
Same idea: we solve our problems by ignoring them (temporarily).
Eliminate the problematic part of the integral using a limit.



$$\int_0^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx = \lim_{a \rightarrow 0^+} \left[\int_a^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx \right] = \lim_{a \rightarrow 0^+} [1 - \sqrt{a}] = 1$$

Evaluate $\int_0^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx$

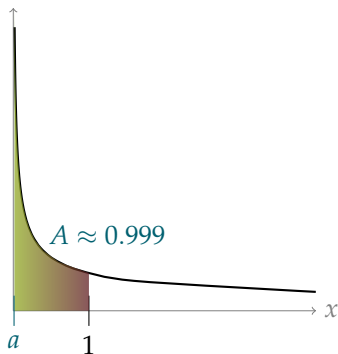
Same idea: we solve our problems by ignoring them (temporarily).
Eliminate the problematic part of the integral using a limit.



$$\int_0^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx = \lim_{a \rightarrow 0^+} \left[\int_a^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx \right] = \lim_{a \rightarrow 0^+} [1 - \sqrt{a}] = 1$$

Evaluate $\int_0^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx$

Same idea: we solve our problems by ignoring them (temporarily).
Eliminate the problematic part of the integral using a limit.



$$\int_0^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx = \lim_{a \rightarrow 0^+} \left[\int_a^1 \frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} dx \right] = \lim_{a \rightarrow 0^+} [1 - \sqrt{a}] = 1$$

Evaluate $\int_{-2}^1 \frac{1}{x^2} dx$

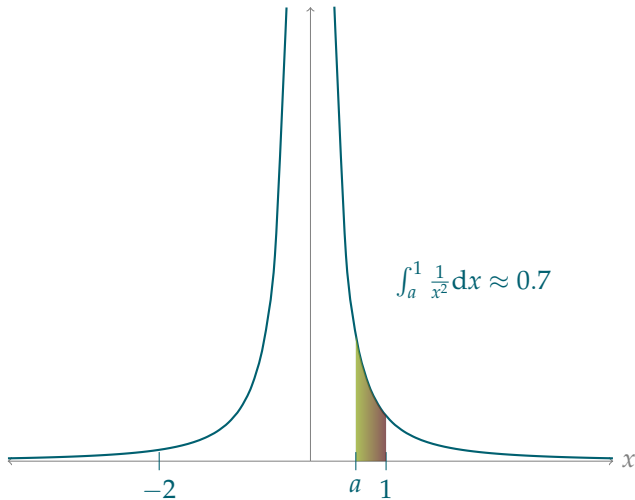
Evaluate $\int_{-2}^1 \frac{1}{x^2} dx$

$$\int x^{-2} dx = -x^{-1} + C = -\frac{1}{x} + C$$

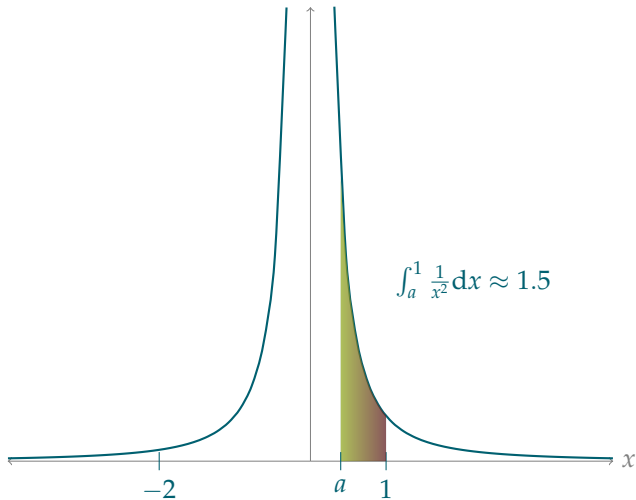
$$\begin{aligned}\lim_{a \rightarrow 0^+} \int_a^1 \frac{1}{x^2} dx &= \lim_{a \rightarrow 0^+} \left[-\frac{1}{x} \right]_a^1 \\ &= \lim_{a \rightarrow 0^+} \left[-1 + \frac{1}{a} \right] = \infty\end{aligned}$$

Once we see that one part of the improper integral diverges, we stop: the entire integral diverges, regardless of what happens to the left of the y -axis.

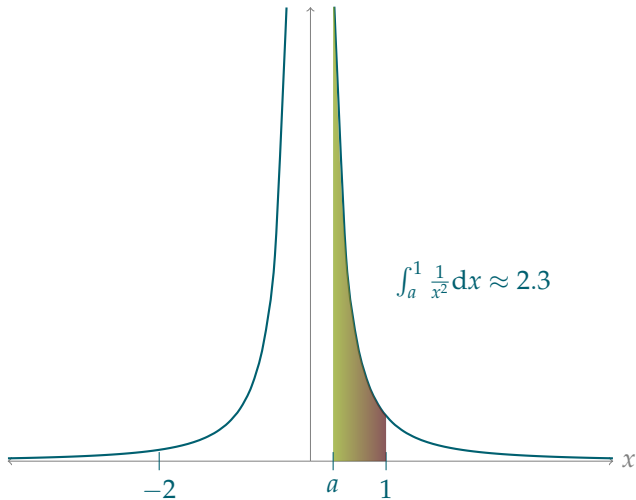
Evaluate $\int_{-2}^1 \frac{1}{x^2} dx$



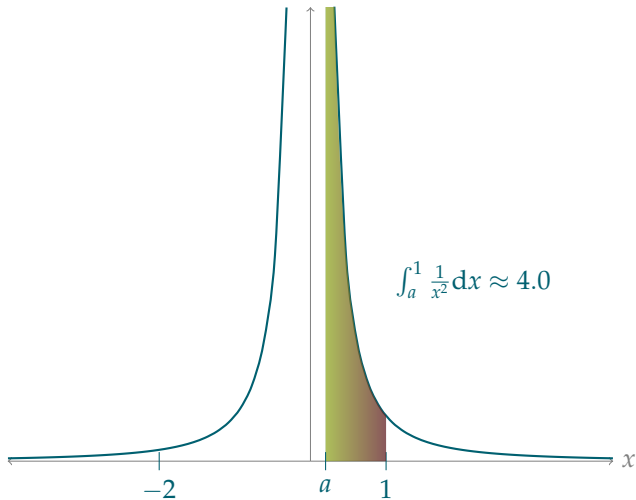
Evaluate $\int_{-2}^1 \frac{1}{x^2} dx$



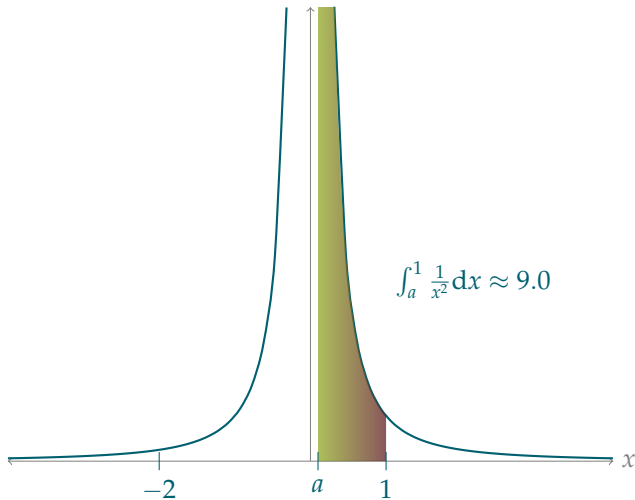
Evaluate $\int_{-2}^1 \frac{1}{x^2} dx$



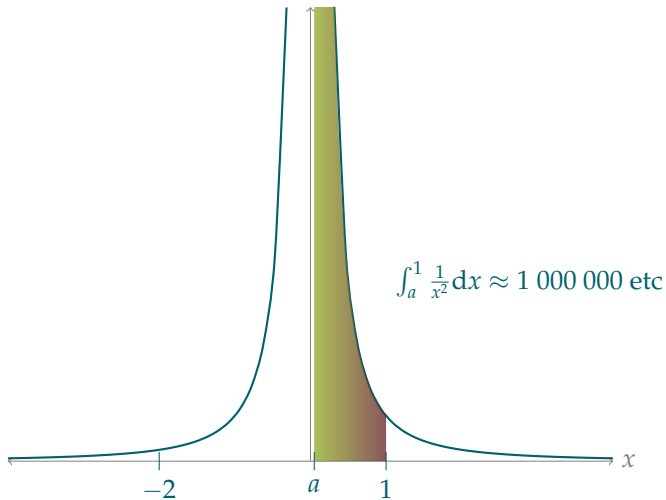
Evaluate $\int_{-2}^1 \frac{1}{x^2} dx$



Evaluate $\int_{-2}^1 \frac{1}{x^2} dx$



Evaluate $\int_{-2}^1 \frac{1}{x^2} dx$



Evaluate $\int_0^{\infty} \frac{\cos x}{1 + \sin^2 x} dx$, or show that it diverges.

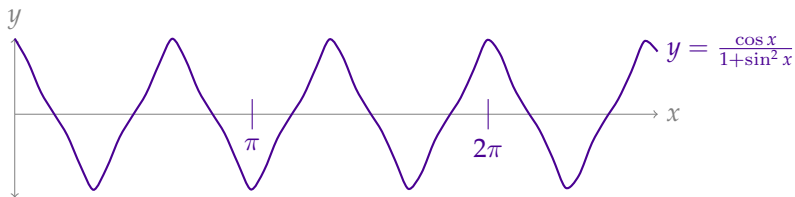
Evaluate $\int_0^{\infty} \frac{\cos x}{1 + \sin^2 x} dx$, or show that it diverges.

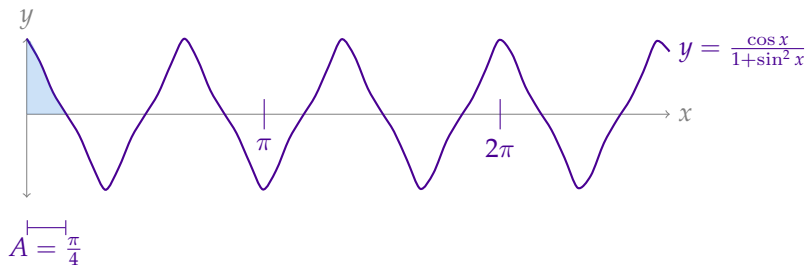
$$u = \sin x, \quad du = \cos x \, dx$$

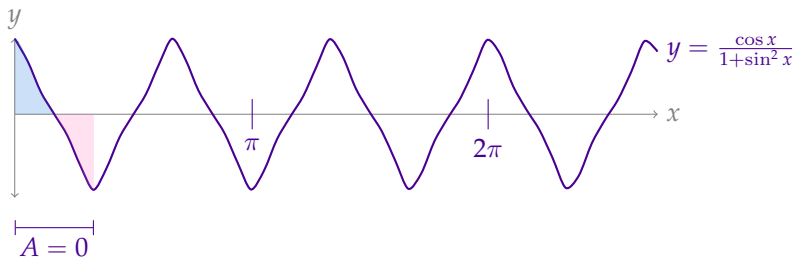
$$u(0) = 0$$

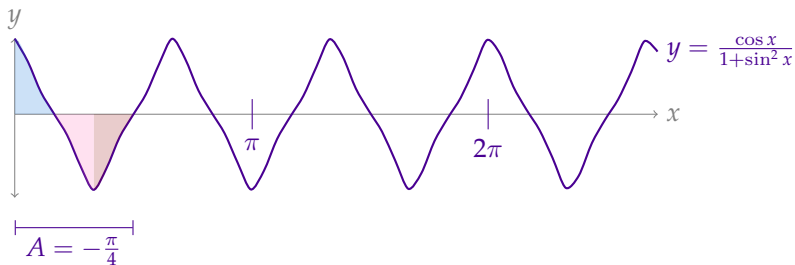
$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_0^b \frac{\cos x}{1 + \sin^2 x} dx \right] &= \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} \left[\int_0^{\sin b} \frac{1}{1 + u^2} du \right] \\ &= \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} [\arctan(\sin b) - \arctan(0)] \\ &= \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} [\arctan(\sin b)] \end{aligned}$$

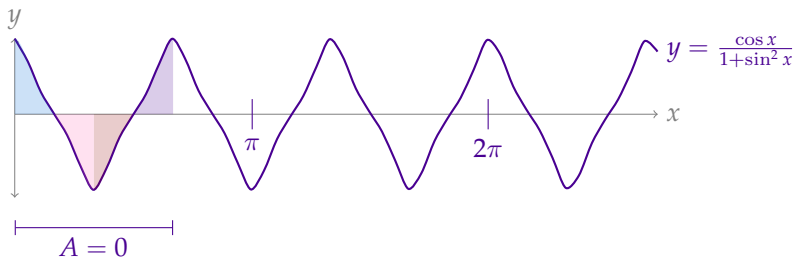
As b goes to infinity, $\sin b$ oscillates between -1 and 1 , so $\arctan(\sin b)$ oscillates between $-\frac{\pi}{4}$ and $\frac{\pi}{4}$. Since its limit does not exist, the integral **diverges**.

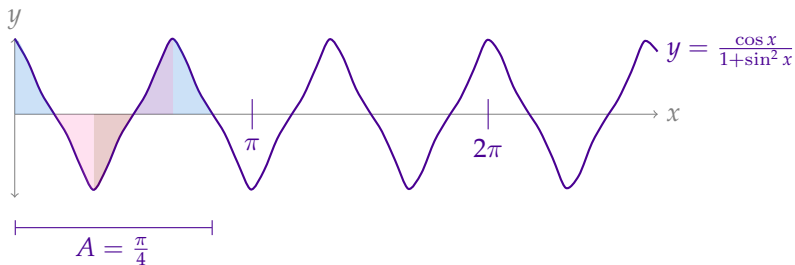


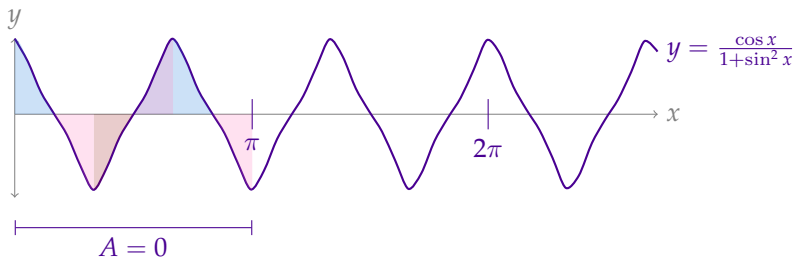


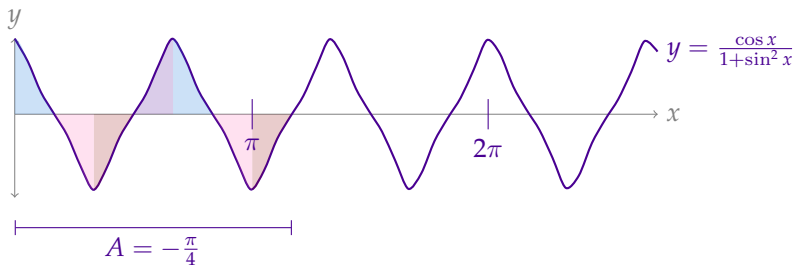


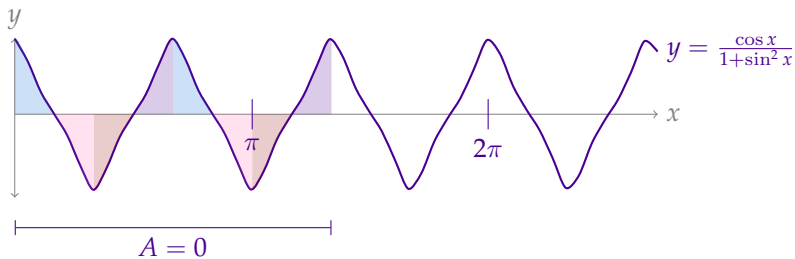


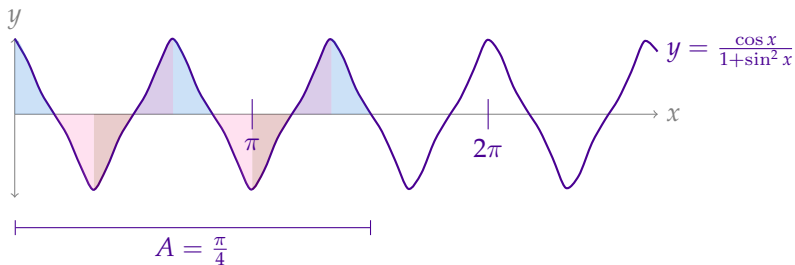


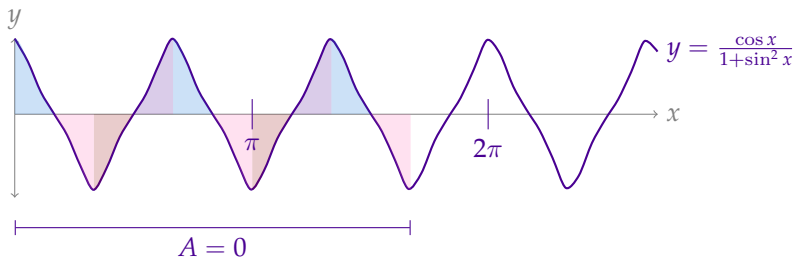


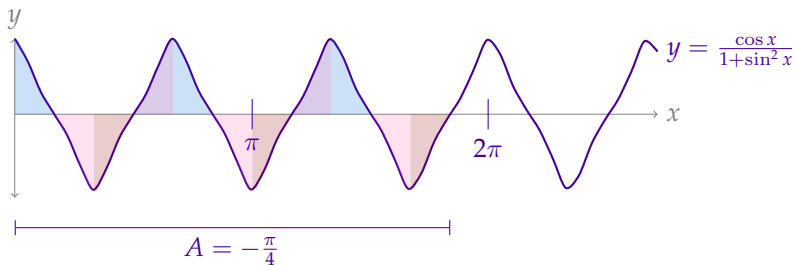


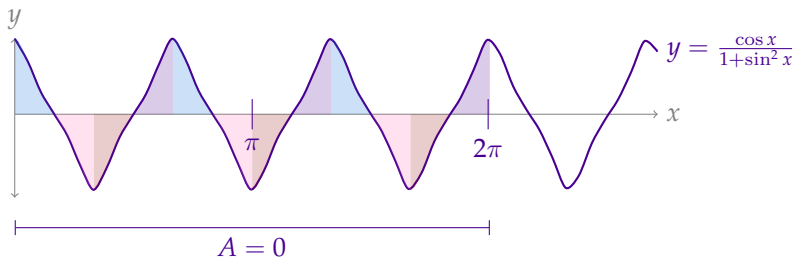


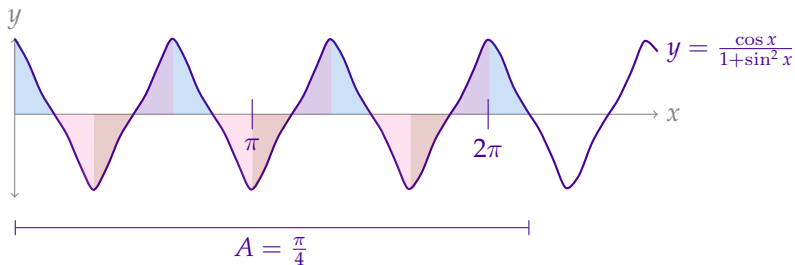


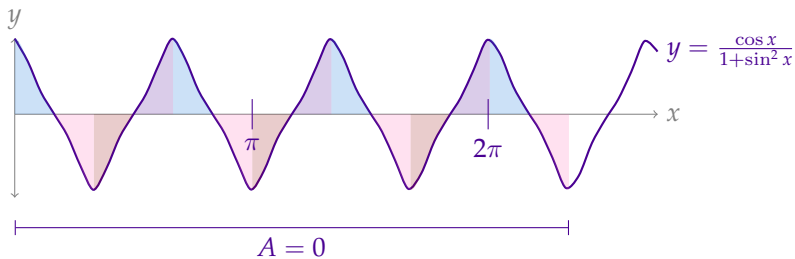


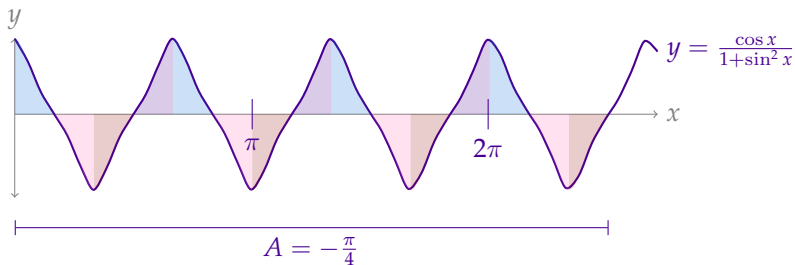


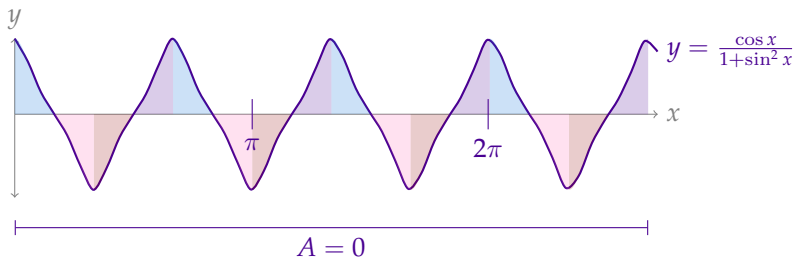












WARNING: SNEAKY DIVERGENCE

If you don't realize that an integral diverges, you can generate answers that look plausible but are secretly nonsense.

For example, attempting to use the Fundamental Theorem of Calculus in the example $\int_{-2}^1 \frac{1}{x^2} dx$ gives $\left[-\frac{1}{x}\right]_{-2}^1 = -\frac{3}{2}$: a poor approximation for positive infinity!

WARNING: SNEAKY DIVERGENCE



approximate integral from -1 to 1 of $1/x^2$ dx using Simpson's rule

NATURAL LANGUAGE
 MATH INPUT
 EXTENDED KEYBOARD
 EXAMPLES
 UPLOAD
 RANDOM

Input interpretation

integrate	$\frac{1}{x^2}$	using Simpson's rule	from $x = -1$ to 1
-----------	-----------------	----------------------	----------------------

Result More digits

0.666667

(using 1 interval)

This mistake can be especially dangerous using computer algebra systems, where you spend less time thinking about the integral and so have fewer chances to notice that something is awry. As of this writing, [WolframAlpha](#) gives no warnings when you ask it to approximate $\int_{-1}^1 \frac{1}{x^2} dx$ using Simpson's Rule: it tells you the approximation with one parabola is $\frac{2}{3}$.

Evaluate $\int_0^1 \frac{1}{x^p} dx$ and $\int_1^\infty \frac{1}{x^p} dx$ when p is constant.

Evaluate $\int_0^1 \frac{1}{x^p} dx$ and $\int_1^\infty \frac{1}{x^p} dx$ when p is constant.

$$\int \frac{1}{x^p} dx = \int x^{-p} dx = \begin{cases} \log |x| + C & \text{if } p = 1 \\ \frac{x^{1-p}}{1-p} + C & \text{if } p \neq 1 \end{cases}$$

$$\int_a^b \frac{1}{x^p} dx = \begin{cases} \log |b| - \log |a| & \text{if } p = 1 \\ \frac{b^{1-p} - a^{1-p}}{1-p} & \text{if } p \neq 1 \end{cases} \quad \text{if } x = 0 \text{ is not in } [a, b]$$

$$\int_1^\infty \frac{1}{x^p} dx = \begin{cases} \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} \log |b| & \text{if } p = 1 \\ \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} \left[\frac{b^{1-p} - 1}{1-p} \right] & \text{if } p \neq 1 \end{cases} : \begin{cases} \text{divergent} & \text{if } p = 1 \\ \text{divergent} & \text{if } p < 1 \\ \frac{1}{p-1} & \text{if } p > 1 \end{cases}$$

$$\int_0^1 \frac{1}{x^p} dx = \begin{cases} \lim_{a \rightarrow 0^+} -\log |a| & \text{if } p = 1 \\ \lim_{a \rightarrow 0^+} \left[\frac{1 - a^{1-p}}{1-p} \right] & \text{if } p \neq 1 \end{cases} : \begin{cases} \text{divergent} & \text{if } p = 1 \\ \frac{1}{1-p} & \text{if } p < 1 \\ \text{divergent} & \text{if } p > 1 \end{cases}$$

p -test

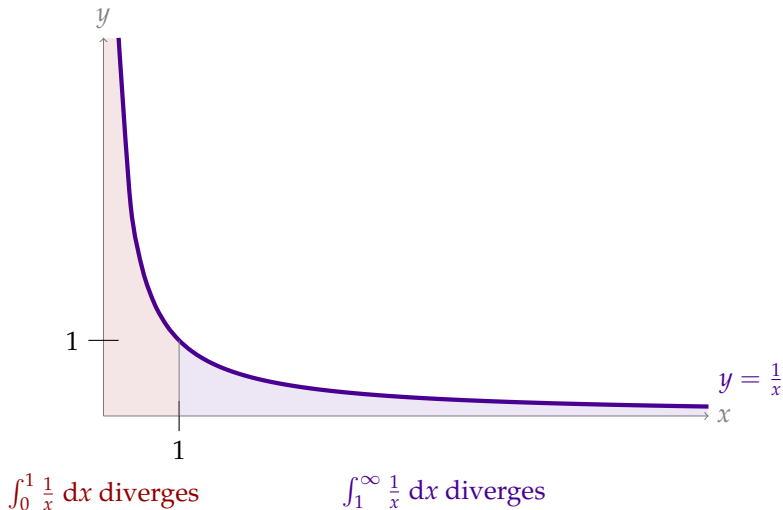
Let p be a constant.

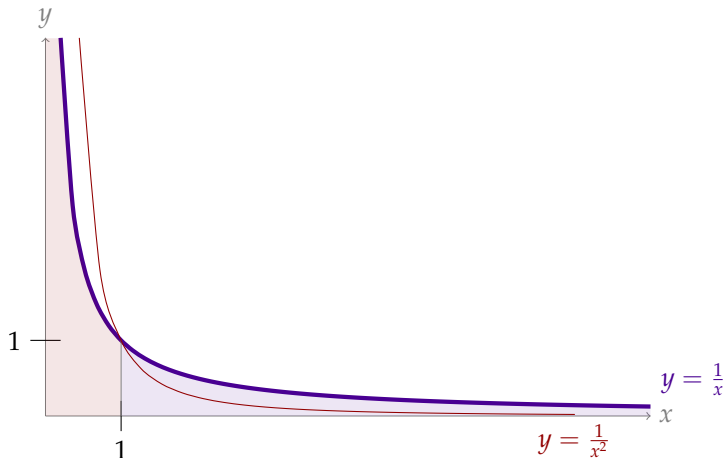
If $p < 1$, then $\int_0^1 \frac{1}{x^p} dx$ converges

If $p \geq 1$, then $\int_0^1 \frac{1}{x^p} dx$ diverges

If $p > 1$, then $\int_1^\infty \frac{1}{x^p} dx$ converges

If $p \leq 1$, then $\int_1^\infty \frac{1}{x^p} dx$ diverges



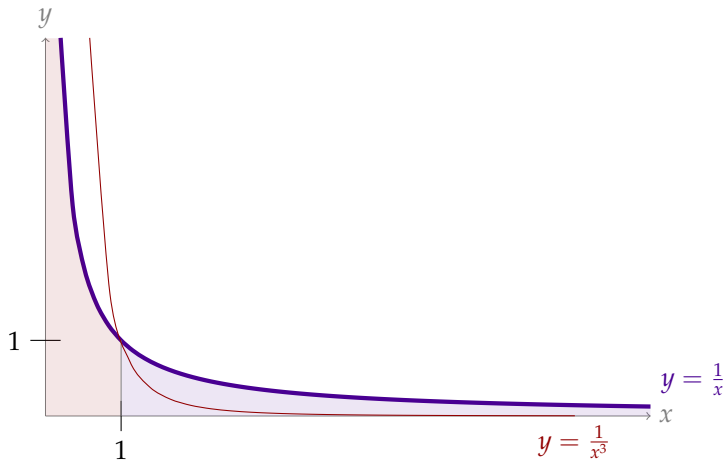


$\int_0^1 \frac{1}{x} dx$ diverges

$\int_1^\infty \frac{1}{x} dx$ diverges

$\int_0^1 \frac{1}{x^2} dx$ diverges

$\int_1^\infty \frac{1}{x^2} dx$ converges

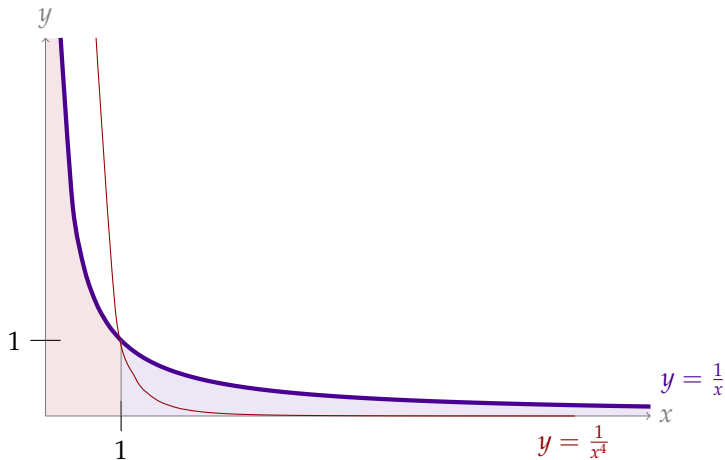


$\int_0^1 \frac{1}{x} dx$ diverges

$\int_1^\infty \frac{1}{x} dx$ diverges

$\int_0^1 \frac{1}{x^3} dx$ diverges

$\int_1^\infty \frac{1}{x^3} dx$ converges

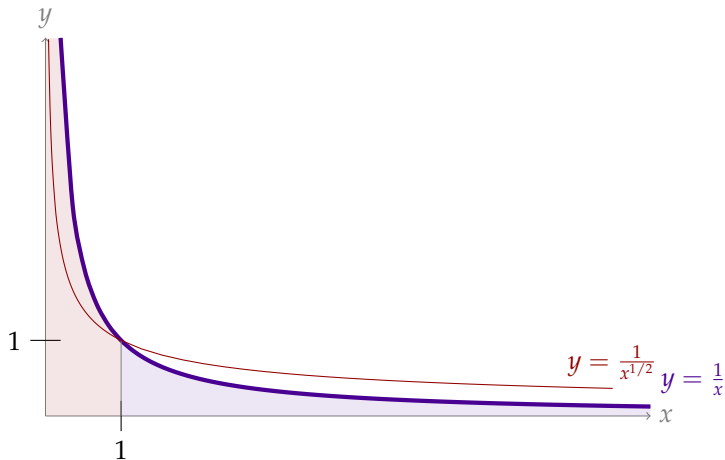


$\int_0^1 \frac{1}{x} dx$ diverges

$\int_1^\infty \frac{1}{x} dx$ diverges

$\int_0^1 \frac{1}{x^4} dx$ diverges

$\int_1^\infty \frac{1}{x^4} dx$ converges

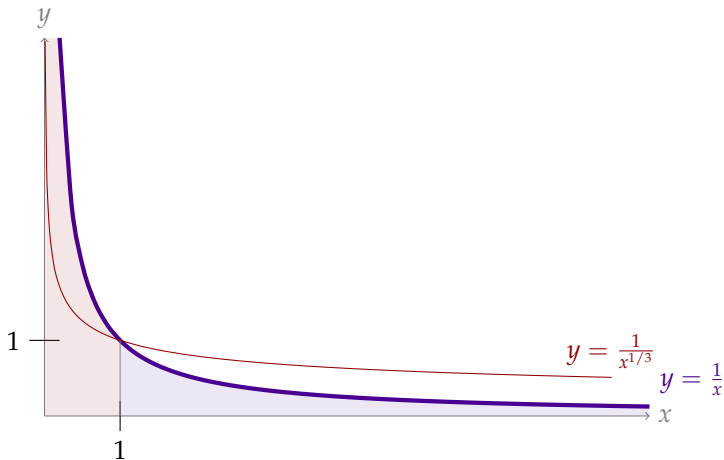


$\int_0^1 \frac{1}{x} dx$ diverges

$\int_1^\infty \frac{1}{x} dx$ diverges

$\int_0^1 \frac{1}{x^{1/2}} dx$ converges

$\int_1^\infty \frac{1}{x^{1/2}} dx$ diverges

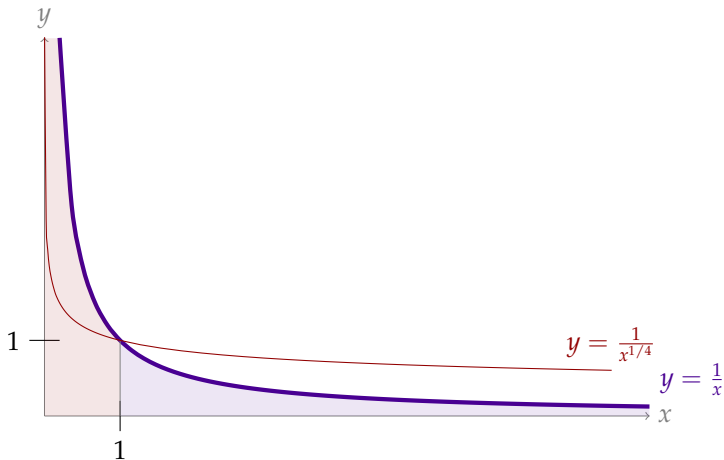


$$\int_0^1 \frac{1}{x} dx \text{ diverges}$$

$$\int_1^\infty \frac{1}{x} dx \text{ diverges}$$

$$\int_0^1 \frac{1}{x^{1/3}} dx \text{ converges}$$

$$\int_1^\infty \frac{1}{x^{1/3}} dx \text{ diverges}$$



$$\int_0^1 \frac{1}{x} dx \text{ diverges}$$

$$\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x} dx \text{ diverges}$$

$$\int_0^1 \frac{1}{x^{1/4}} dx \text{ converges}$$

$$\int_0^1 \frac{1}{x^{1/4}} dx \text{ diverges}$$

Decide whether each integral converges or diverges.

$$\blacktriangleright \int_0^1 \frac{1}{x^{1/3}} dx$$

$$\blacktriangleright \int_0^1 \frac{1}{\sqrt{x}} dx$$

$$\blacktriangleright \int_0^1 \frac{1}{x} dx$$

$$\blacktriangleright \int_0^1 \frac{1}{x^{1.5}} dx$$

$$\blacktriangleright \int_1^\infty \frac{1}{x^{1/3}} dx$$

$$\blacktriangleright \int_1^\infty \frac{1}{\sqrt{x}} dx$$

$$\blacktriangleright \int_1^\infty \frac{1}{x} dx$$

$$\blacktriangleright \int_1^\infty \frac{1}{x^{1.5}} dx$$

Decide whether each integral converges or diverges.

$$\blacktriangleright \int_0^1 \frac{1}{x^{1/3}} dx \text{ converges}$$

$$\blacktriangleright \int_0^1 \frac{1}{\sqrt{x}} dx \text{ converges}$$

$$\blacktriangleright \int_0^1 \frac{1}{x} dx \text{ diverges}$$

$$\blacktriangleright \int_0^1 \frac{1}{x^{1.5}} dx \text{ diverges}$$

$$\blacktriangleright \int_1^\infty \frac{1}{x^{1/3}} dx \text{ diverges}$$

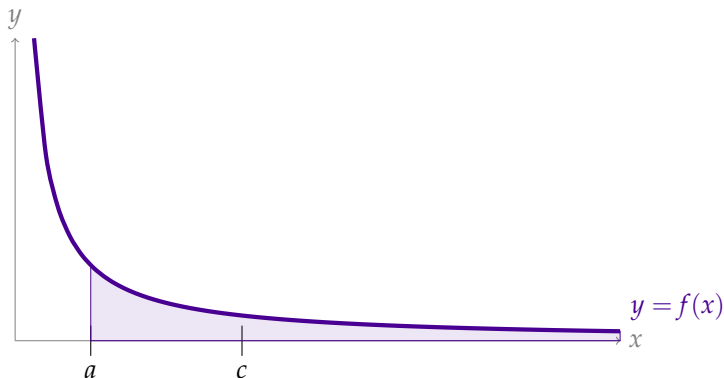
$$\blacktriangleright \int_1^\infty \frac{1}{\sqrt{x}} dx \text{ diverges}$$

$$\blacktriangleright \int_1^\infty \frac{1}{x} dx \text{ diverges}$$

$$\blacktriangleright \int_1^\infty \frac{1}{x^{1.5}} dx \text{ converges}$$

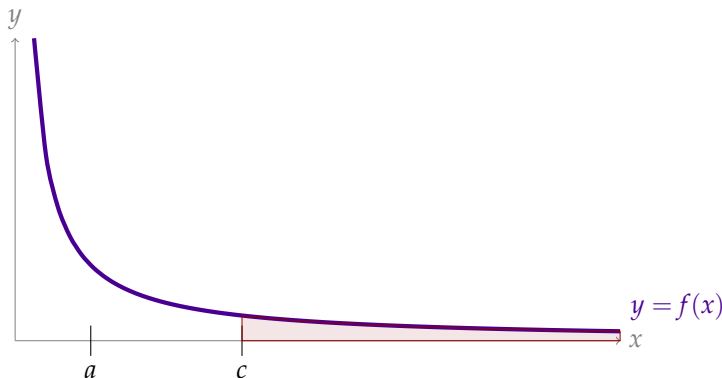
Theorem 1.12.20

Let a and c be real numbers with $a < c$ and let the function $f(x)$ be continuous for all $x \geq a$. Then the improper integral $\int_a^\infty f(x) dx$ converges if and only if the improper integral $\int_c^\infty f(x) dx$ converges.



Theorem 1.12.20

Let a and c be real numbers with $a < c$ and let the function $f(x)$ be continuous for all $x \geq a$. Then the improper integral $\int_a^\infty f(x) dx$ converges if and only if the improper integral $\int_c^\infty f(x) dx$ converges.



Decide whether each integral converges or diverges.

$$\blacktriangleright \int_0^9 \frac{1}{x^{0.3}} dx$$

$$\blacktriangleright \int_0^{81} \frac{1}{x^2} dx$$

$$\blacktriangleright \int_0^{\frac{1}{2}} \frac{1}{x^3} dx$$

$$\blacktriangleright \int_{15}^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^{0.3}} dx$$

$$\blacktriangleright \int_{0.4}^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^2} dx$$

$$\blacktriangleright \int_{\frac{1}{2}}^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^3} dx$$

Decide whether each integral converges or diverges.

▶ $\int_0^9 \frac{1}{x^{0.3}} dx$ converges

▶ $\int_0^{81} \frac{1}{x^2} dx$ diverges

▶ $\int_0^{\frac{1}{2}} \frac{1}{x^3} dx$ diverges

▶ $\int_{15}^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^{0.3}} dx$ diverges

▶ $\int_{0.4}^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^2} dx$ converges

▶ $\int_{\frac{1}{2}}^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^3} dx$ converges

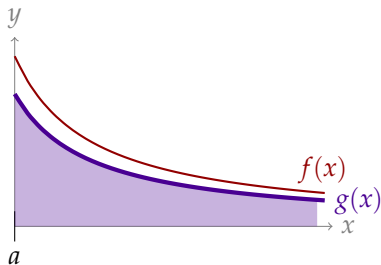
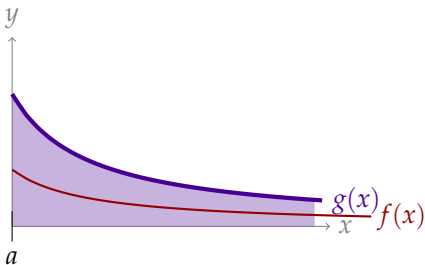
It is very common to encounter integrals that are too complicated to evaluate explicitly. Numerical approximation schemes, evaluated by computer, are often used instead. You want to be sure that at least the integral converges before feeding it into a computer.

Fortunately it is usually possible to determine whether or not an improper integral converges even when you cannot evaluate it explicitly.

Comparison

Let a be a real number. Let f and g be functions that are defined and continuous for all $x \geq a$ and assume that $g(x) \geq 0$ for all $x \geq a$.

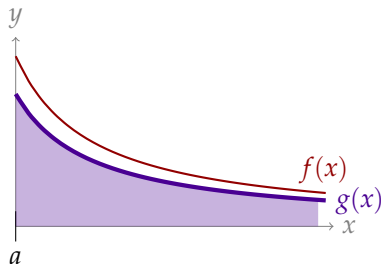
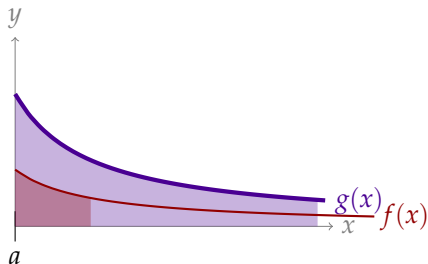
- (a) If $|f(x)| \leq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$ and if $\int_a^\infty g(x) \, dx$ converges, then $\int_a^\infty f(x) \, dx$ converges.
- (b) If $f(x) \geq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$ and if $\int_a^\infty g(x) \, dx$ diverges, then $\int_a^\infty f(x) \, dx$ diverges.



Comparison

Let a be a real number. Let f and g be functions that are defined and continuous for all $x \geq a$ and assume that $g(x) \geq 0$ for all $x \geq a$.

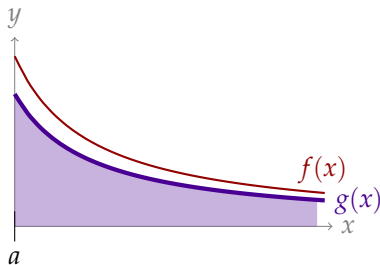
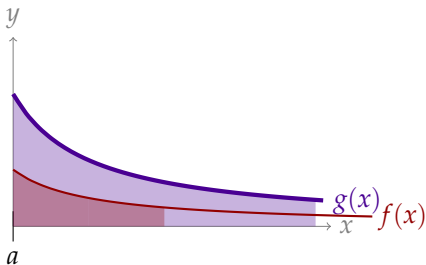
- (a) If $|f(x)| \leq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$ and if $\int_a^\infty g(x) \, dx$ converges, then $\int_a^\infty f(x) \, dx$ converges.
- (b) If $f(x) \geq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$ and if $\int_a^\infty g(x) \, dx$ diverges, then $\int_a^\infty f(x) \, dx$ diverges.



Comparison

Let a be a real number. Let f and g be functions that are defined and continuous for all $x \geq a$ and assume that $g(x) \geq 0$ for all $x \geq a$.

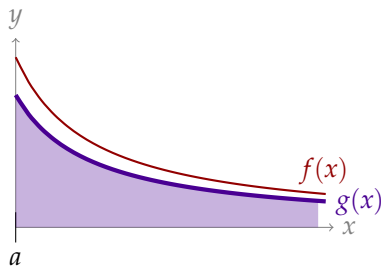
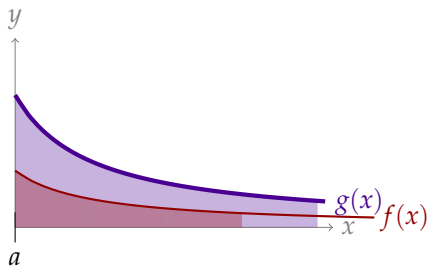
- (a) If $|f(x)| \leq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$ and if $\int_a^\infty g(x) \, dx$ converges, then $\int_a^\infty f(x) \, dx$ converges.
- (b) If $f(x) \geq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$ and if $\int_a^\infty g(x) \, dx$ diverges, then $\int_a^\infty f(x) \, dx$ diverges.



Comparison

Let a be a real number. Let f and g be functions that are defined and continuous for all $x \geq a$ and assume that $g(x) \geq 0$ for all $x \geq a$.

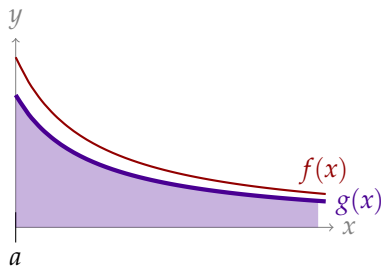
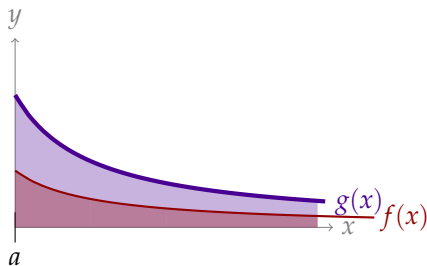
- (a) If $|f(x)| \leq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$ and if $\int_a^\infty g(x) \, dx$ converges, then $\int_a^\infty f(x) \, dx$ converges.
- (b) If $f(x) \geq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$ and if $\int_a^\infty g(x) \, dx$ diverges, then $\int_a^\infty f(x) \, dx$ diverges.



Comparison

Let a be a real number. Let f and g be functions that are defined and continuous for all $x \geq a$ and assume that $g(x) \geq 0$ for all $x \geq a$.

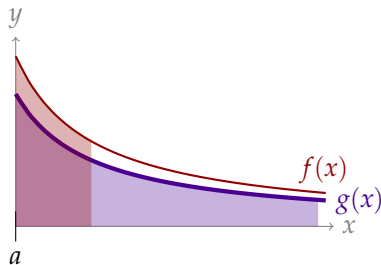
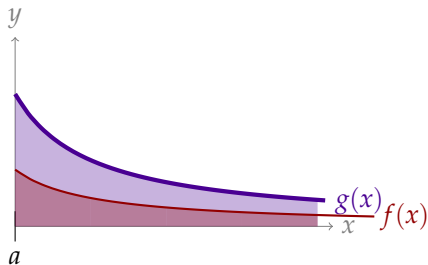
- (a) If $|f(x)| \leq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$ and if $\int_a^\infty g(x) \, dx$ converges, then $\int_a^\infty f(x) \, dx$ converges.
- (b) If $f(x) \geq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$ and if $\int_a^\infty g(x) \, dx$ diverges, then $\int_a^\infty f(x) \, dx$ diverges.



Comparison

Let a be a real number. Let f and g be functions that are defined and continuous for all $x \geq a$ and assume that $g(x) \geq 0$ for all $x \geq a$.

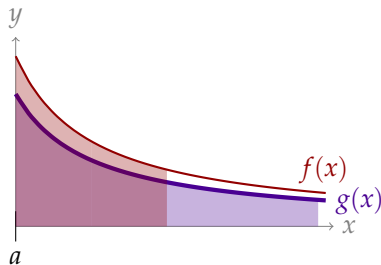
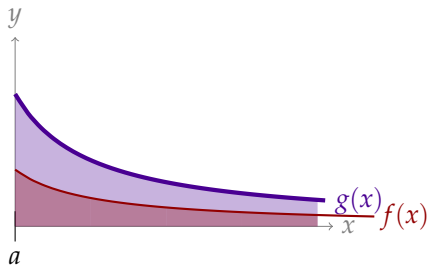
- (a) If $|f(x)| \leq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$ and if $\int_a^\infty g(x) \, dx$ converges, then $\int_a^\infty f(x) \, dx$ converges.
- (b) If $f(x) \geq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$ and if $\int_a^\infty g(x) \, dx$ diverges, then $\int_a^\infty f(x) \, dx$ diverges.



Comparison

Let a be a real number. Let f and g be functions that are defined and continuous for all $x \geq a$ and assume that $g(x) \geq 0$ for all $x \geq a$.

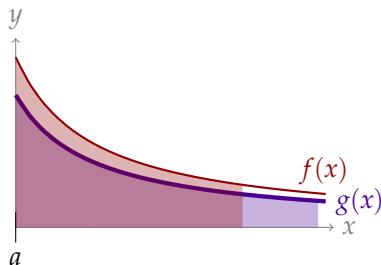
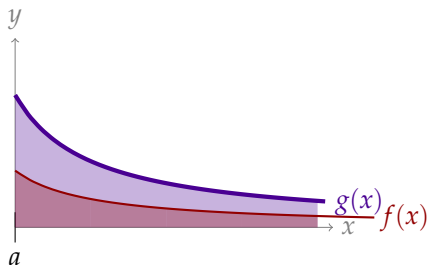
- (a) If $|f(x)| \leq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$ and if $\int_a^\infty g(x) \, dx$ converges, then $\int_a^\infty f(x) \, dx$ converges.
- (b) If $f(x) \geq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$ and if $\int_a^\infty g(x) \, dx$ diverges, then $\int_a^\infty f(x) \, dx$ diverges.



Comparison

Let a be a real number. Let f and g be functions that are defined and continuous for all $x \geq a$ and assume that $g(x) \geq 0$ for all $x \geq a$.

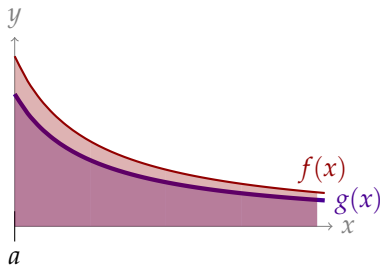
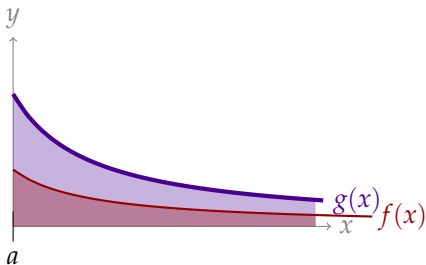
- (a) If $|f(x)| \leq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$ and if $\int_a^\infty g(x) \, dx$ converges, then $\int_a^\infty f(x) \, dx$ converges.
- (b) If $f(x) \geq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$ and if $\int_a^\infty g(x) \, dx$ diverges, then $\int_a^\infty f(x) \, dx$ diverges.



Comparison

Let a be a real number. Let f and g be functions that are defined and continuous for all $x \geq a$ and assume that $g(x) \geq 0$ for all $x \geq a$.

- (a) If $|f(x)| \leq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$ and if $\int_a^\infty g(x) \, dx$ converges, then $\int_a^\infty f(x) \, dx$ converges.
- (b) If $f(x) \geq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$ and if $\int_a^\infty g(x) \, dx$ diverges, then $\int_a^\infty f(x) \, dx$ diverges.



Does the integral $\int_1^{\infty} e^{-x^2}$ converge or diverge?

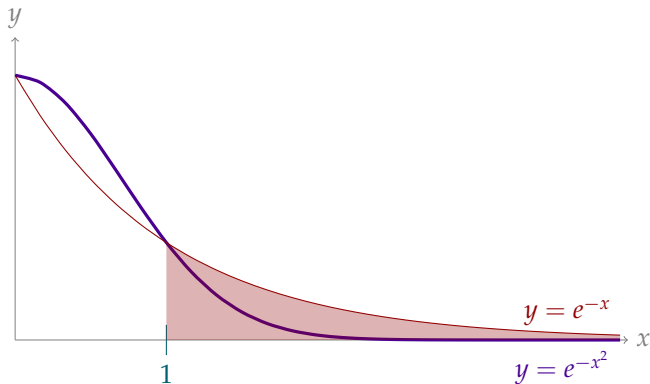
Does the integral $\int_1^{\infty} e^{-x^2}$ converge or diverge?

We know from previous examples that we can't evaluate $\int e^{-x^2} dx$ directly. For $x \geq 1$:

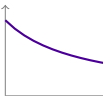
$$\begin{aligned}x^2 > x &\implies -x^2 < -x \implies e^{-x^2} < e^{-x} \\ \int_1^{\infty} e^{-x} dx &= \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} \int_1^b e^{-x} dx \\ &= \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} [-e^{-x}]_1^b \\ &= \lim_{b \rightarrow \infty} [e^{-b} - e^{-1}] \\ &= e^{-1} = \frac{1}{e}\end{aligned}$$

Since $0 \leq e^{-x^2} \leq e^{-x}$ for $x \geq 1$, and since $\int_1^{\infty} e^{-x} dx$ converges, by the comparison test we conclude that $\int e^{-x^2} dx$ converges, as well.

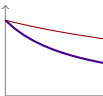
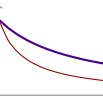
Does the integral $\int_1^{\infty} e^{-x^2}$ converge or diverge?



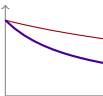
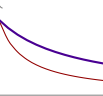
Let functions $f(x)$ and $g(x)$ be positive and continuous for all $x \geq a$.

		$\int_a^{\infty} g(x) dx$
	$f(x) \leq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$	
	$f(x) \geq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$	

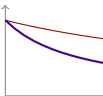
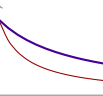
Let functions $f(x)$ and $g(x)$ be positive and continuous for all $x \geq a$.

		$\int_a^{\infty} g(x) dx$
	$f(x) \leq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$	
	$f(x) \geq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$	

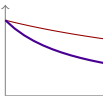
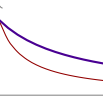
Let functions $f(x)$ and $g(x)$ be positive and continuous for all $x \geq a$.

		$\int_a^\infty g(x)$
	$f(x) \leq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$	 $\int_a^\infty f(x)$
	$f(x) \geq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$	

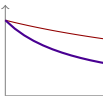
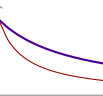
Let functions $f(x)$ and $g(x)$ be positive and continuous for all $x \geq a$.

		$\int_a^\infty g(x)$
	$f(x) \leq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$	 $\int_a^\infty f(x)$
	$f(x) \geq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$	

Let functions $f(x)$ and $g(x)$ be positive and continuous for all $x \geq a$.

		$\int_a^\infty g(x) dx$
	$f(x) \leq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$	 $\int_a^\infty f(x) dx$
	$f(x) \geq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$	 incon

Let functions $f(x)$ and $g(x)$ be positive and continuous for all $x \geq a$.

		$\int_a^\infty g(x)$
	$f(x) \leq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$	 $\int_a^\infty f(x)$
	$f(x) \geq g(x)$ for all $x \geq a$	 incon

For each example below, decide whether the statement is a valid use of the comparison theorem.

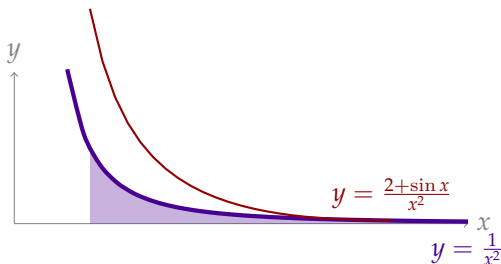
- ▶ $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^2} dx$ converges and $0 \leq \frac{1}{x^2} \leq \frac{2+\sin x}{x^2}$ for $x \geq 1$. So by the comparison test, $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{2+\sin x}{x^2} dx$ converges as well.
- ▶ $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^2} dx$ converges and $0 \leq \frac{e^{-x}}{x^2} \leq \frac{1}{x^2}$ for $x \geq 1$. So by the comparison test, $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{e^{-x}}{x^2} dx$ converges as well.
- ▶ $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^2} dx$ converges and $-\frac{1}{x} \leq \frac{1}{x^2}$ for $x \geq 1$. So by the comparison test, $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{-1}{x} dx$ converges as well.

For each example below, decide whether the statement is a valid use of the comparison theorem.

- $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^2} dx$ converges and $0 \leq \frac{1}{x^2} \leq \frac{2+\sin x}{x^2}$ for $x \geq 1$. So by the comparison test, $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{2+\sin x}{x^2} dx$ converges as well.

For each example below, decide whether the statement is a valid use of the comparison theorem.

- $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^2} dx$ converges and $0 \leq \frac{1}{x^2} \leq \frac{2+\sin x}{x^2}$ for $x \geq 1$. So by the comparison test, $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{2+\sin x}{x^2} dx$ converges as well.



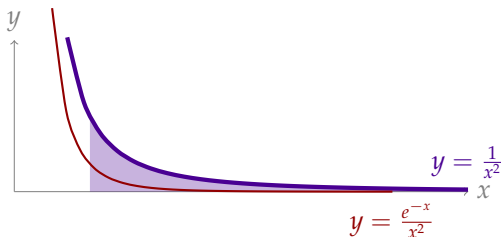
invalid

For each example below, decide whether the statement is a valid use of the comparison theorem.

- $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^2} dx$ converges and $0 \leq \frac{e^{-x}}{x^2} \leq \frac{1}{x^2}$ for $x \geq 1$. So by the comparison test, $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{e^{-x}}{x^2} dx$ converges as well.

For each example below, decide whether the statement is a valid use of the comparison theorem.

- $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^2} dx$ converges and $0 \leq \frac{e^{-x}}{x^2} \leq \frac{1}{x^2}$ for $x \geq 1$. So by the comparison test, $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{e^{-x}}{x^2} dx$ converges as well.



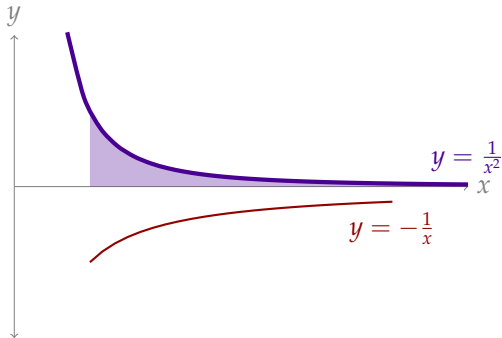
valid

For each example below, decide whether the statement is a valid use of the comparison theorem.

- $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^2} dx$ converges and $-\frac{1}{x} \leq \frac{1}{x^2}$ for $x \geq 1$. So by the comparison test, $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{-1}{x} dx$ converges as well.

For each example below, decide whether the statement is a valid use of the comparison theorem.

- $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x^2} dx$ converges and $-\frac{1}{x} \leq \frac{1}{x^2}$ for $x \geq 1$. So by the comparison test, $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{-1}{x} dx$ converges as well.



invalid

Limiting comparison

Let $-\infty < a < \infty$. Let f and g be functions that are defined and continuous for all $x \geq a$ and assume that $g(x) \geq 0$ for all $x \geq a$.

If the limit

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{f(x)}{g(x)}$$

exists and is nonzero, then either $\int_a^\infty f(x) \, dx$ and $\int_a^\infty g(x) \, dx$ both converge, or they both diverge.

Limiting comparison

Let $-\infty < a < \infty$. Let f and g be functions that are defined and continuous for all $x \geq a$ and assume that $g(x) \geq 0$ for all $x \geq a$.

If the limit

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{f(x)}{g(x)}$$

exists and is nonzero, then either $\int_a^\infty f(x) \, dx$ and $\int_a^\infty g(x) \, dx$ both converge, or they both diverge.

Use limiting comparison to determine whether $\int_1^\infty \frac{1}{x+10} \, dx$ converges or diverges.

Use limiting comparison to determine whether $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x+10} dx$ converges or diverges.

Use limiting comparison to determine whether $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x+10} dx$ converges or diverges.

An integrand that looks similar and simpler is $\frac{1}{x}$. Since $\frac{1}{x+10} < \frac{1}{x}$ and $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x} dx$ diverges, we can't directly compare the two series. So, let's use limiting comparison. Set $f(x) = \frac{1}{x}$ and $g(x) = \frac{1}{x+10}$. Then:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{f(x)}{g(x)} = \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1/x}{1/(x+10)} = \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{x+10}{x} = 1$$

Since 1 is nonzero and finite, the integrals either both converge or both diverge. Since $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x} dx$ diverges, we conclude $\int_1^{\infty} \frac{1}{x+10} dx$ diverges as well.

Included Work



'Notebook' by [Iconic](#) is licensed under [CC BY 3.0](#) (accessed 9 June 2021), 27, 111, 119



[WolframAlpha](#) (accessed 25 August 2021) , 75